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General Comment

1. The combination of unregulated data center growth, cooling demands, and aging electrical infrastructure has begun to cause inconsistencies in utility services that will prove enormously costly to consumers. Data centers and energy companies should not be allowed to offload these costs to the government or pass them on to the American public in the form of higher electrical rates or water costs. Companies seeking to build new data centers should bear the associated costs of those centers to the public, either through taxes or graduated rate differentials.
2. AI developers must not be given an exemption from copyright laws. Creating a carve-out from protections that are rigorously defended by corporations and clearly articulated in centuries of case law will weaken the system as a whole. At heart, generative AI does not exist outside of the content used to train it, so to detach that content from the applicable legal framework makes the traditional notion of copyright and protection of the ingenuity of creators meaningless. Developers should negotiate with rights holders, and those negotiations should also include extensive protections for the privacy and safety of individuals connected to the works used, either as subjects or creators.
3. Consumers, viewers, and readers should be given the opportunity to make informed decisions about generative AI. Failing to distinguish between the creative output of humans and the derivative products of AI is harmful to communication in general, and to scientific discovery, news media, literature, and education in particular. Just as with copyright declarations of source materials, publication of AI-produced material should include a clear statement of how and to what extent generative AI has been employed.